

Scilab editor

There are many disadvantages of typing the commands directly in the console window. It is difficult to edit multiple instructions and you cannot save the commands. This is where SciNotes is used. You can launch SciNotes by clicking on the first icon in the toolbar, or go to Applications > SciNotes.

The closing of opened parentheses, end loops, function and test commands are added automatically in the text editor. This can be disabled from menu bar Options > Auto-completion on, and selecting '(, [, ...' or 'if, function, ...' or both. Each instruction is to be entered in a separate line.

If multiple sentences are entered in the same line, they should be separated by a semicolon (;). You can exclude a line from the execution. For example, when you want to add a comment, add '//' at the start of the line. Go to Options > Preferences to change font type, colour and other general settings. Fig.

TABLE II
Basic Numerical Calculations

Function	Operation
+	Addition
-	Subtraction
*	Multiplication
/	Division
^	Exponent
sqrt ()	Square root
exp()	Exponential
log()	Natural logarithm
%e	Mathematical constant 'e'
%pi	Mathematical constant 'π'
%i	Complex number 'i'

2 shows the SciNote window which features a program to calculate ten terms of the sequence defined by $u_1 = 1$, $u_{n+1} = 2u_n - 3$.

```
//Calculation of ten terms
u(1)=1
for n=1:10
```

```
u(n+1)=2*u(n)-3
disp(n, [u(n)])
end
```

Click on Save and execute icon in the toolbar, or go to Execute > Save and execute, or press F5 on keyboard to save the instructions typed in SciNotes, and execute it in the console.

Scilab help

A lot more complex features are also available in Scilab which are beyond the scope of this article. Fortunately, Scilab comes with a simple and elaborate embedded help menu that has listed every available function. The user can access the help window from the menu bar: ? > Scilab Help. Pressing F1 key also opens the help window. Alternatively, type:

```
-->help
```

in the console and press Enter/Return to get help. ●

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